



**STRATHMORE UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF COMMERCE
Bachelor of Commerce
END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION
HED 2101: PRINCIPLES OF ETHICS
EVENING CLASS**

DATE: 12th April 2011

TOTAL 60 MARKS

TIME: 2 Hours

Instructions:

Answer QUESTION ONE and any other TWO questions from section B

SECTION A – COMPULSORY

QUESTION ONE: (30 MARKS)

The Polluter's Dilemma

Monica Okide is the environmental compliance manager for a small plastics manufacturing company. She is currently faced with the decision whether or not to spend money on new technology that will reduce the level of a particular toxin in the wastewater that flows out the back of the factory and into a lake. The factory's emission levels are already within legal limits. However, Monica knows that environmental regulations for this particular toxin are lagging behind scientific evidence. In fact, a scientist from the Great Lakes University had been quoted in the newspaper recently, saying that if emission levels stayed at this level, the fish in the lakes and rivers in the area might soon have to be declared unsafe for human consumption.

Further, if companies in the region don't engage in some self-regulation on this issue, there is reason to fear that the government — backed by public opinion — may force companies to begin using the new technology, and may also begin requiring monthly emission level reports (which would be both expensive and time consuming). But the company's environmental compliance budget is tight. Asking for this new technology to be installed would put Monica's department over-budget, and could jeopardize the company's ability to show a profit this year.

I. Question One (a) (20 Marks)

- a) Identify the object, end and circumstances which Monica needs to deal with to make her decision (3 Marks)
- b) Assess the moral value of the object, end and circumstances in terms of the Natural Law and/or moral virtues and the good life (6 marks)
- c) Decide which is the best way for her to act in moral terms, and justify your decision by explaining the overall moral value for the decision (3 Marks)
- d) What motives would the company have to install the new technology? (3 Marks)
- e) What motives would the company have to *delay* installing the new technology? (3 Marks)
- f) Why might the companies in this region *prefer* for the government to impose new regulations? (2 Marks)

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Question One (b)

After a semester where you have studied Principles of Ethics, you decide to give a talk to your friends/colleagues in order to help them understand about the 'good life'. In your talk explain: "What is happiness?" highlighting **FIVE** key points **(10 Marks)**

SECTION B – ANSWER ANY TWO QUESTIONS

Question Two (15 Marks)

Freedom is a true expression of self-determination of the person. With the help of examples discuss the following **(15 Marks)**

- a) **Freedom and Commitment**
- b) **Freedom and Responsibility**
- c) **Freedom and Authority**

Question Three (15 Marks)

Discuss what you understand by the following terms in the context of Principles of Ethics

- a) **1st moral principles or Synderisis:**
- b) **Natural Moral Law**
- c) **Moral conscience or Conscience**

Question Four (15 Marks)

Moral Virtue is a rational criterion that regulates the good, desires, feelings and actions. Based on the three dimensions of virtues and vices, discuss the role of virtues, sentiments and affectivity in the realization of a morally good life.